

# ART OF ESCAPE

## THE MEETING AT CHIEF'S HOME

**Chief:** Am late but not the late (*laughs*)

we plan for the village, we decision what takes place here.

Guess what,

When I was sleeping, the angel came to me, she saying we are to getting rich

This deal is so appetizing

(*listens to fellow member*)

**Members:** commander namba moja tell us tell us.

Oukay, oukay, I wasn'ting put in this positions not because am a brother to the king.

It because my coconut works very well.

As you knowing our people are farmers and we are not deserving to be here even

We introduce a small tax and promise these villagers fertilizers.

**Oberi:** eeh I think that can work if we truly buy the fertilizers for them

As you know, we all benefit from this community and these people.....

**Gally:** (*interrupts oberi*) ohh ohh ohh be quiet even

Our soils are already fertile, we have not even gotten some good money yet to enjoy life.

We should collect this money, pack soil in bags and sell to these villagers, do they even have sense! (chief moves off stage because he is called)

We will get our own people, give them something and say, they are the experienced people who putt fertilizers in soil.

**Others:**

Wabula guy oyiya, we are proud of this committee

**Oberi:** What if the villagers find out that we are scamming them.

**Gally:** shut up,( *chief comes back*) you who can't even head your family, you have the guts to speak when men are talking.

**Chief:** my intelligent persons, I have receiving some good and bad news.  
What should I start with,

**Oberi:** bad news

**Gally:** good news.

**Chief:** oukay good news, we have receiving 2 billions shillings to aids in our government works.

**Gally:** woowoow another one.....

**Chief:**( *chief interrupts gally*)

But in a times not knowing, the king senting someone to monitor our working schools, hospital and roads and how we use our offices.

**Gally:** will he send the prime minister

**Chief:** I don't knowing, the person sent me don't know him. He might even be here now.

**Oberi:** if that guy is already here, let us not collect the money for fertilizers, and lets allocate this 2 billions and we correct some mistakes

**Gally:** aaaaaaaaaaah. Let us collect the money, we will even give this minister kintu kidogo, you think these guys are well off, waaaa, they also need money.

**Chief:** the rest move out, let me remain with Gally.

*(moves outside with gally)*

### **AT OBERI'S HOME**

*(Woman comes complaining throws saucepans down and gears take them to the kitchen*

*Man enters the house, sleeps on sofa,*

*Wife finds him, she feels like slapping, but decides to bring water, pours on his head.)*

**Wife** *(shouts)* go and bathe, *( speaks calmly)* in whose house are you going to sleep minus bathing without bathing.

*(man moves away angrily)*

*(Wife move away).*

When you look at him, you think he is a man.

### **IN A GARDEN**

*Chief comes with a hoe starts digging.*

*(Okweri comes running)*

**Okweri:**Good news chief,

There was a man who was staring at us yesterday, I tried to monitor him, and the guy is renting in an expensive apartment, that guy might be the minister.

**Chief:** do you know what, *(chief becomes happy, holds their hands and starts moving away)* I have assigned you that, any man you want to convince that guy, I will give you.

### **AT THE ROAD**

**Man**☹ (*A stressed young man dressed smartly*) what will I eat today, hope they wont find me in this village , I have eaten peoples gambled even the little I was left with hoping to get more, ehh life isn't fair

**Okweri and friend:**

Boss, how is the work you are doing, we received the money, and we promise everything moves on as our king planned it.

Its better we go get some lunch.

**Man:** am alright, no need for lunch. ( *these people want to take me to police*)

**Okweri:** ohhh, we know good and honored people like you are always fine, anyways take this little 200k, as you know we get from our little salaries and help people.

**Man:** no no, (but they put the money in his pocket)

Ehh what is going on, let me run before its too late, but wait I heard of the inspections from the king. They ,might be thinking that am the minister.

Let me stay and get money for loans and I run away( *move away happily jumping*)

(*Chief comes with books,*

*Finds okweri on the way*)

**Chief:** how is everything so far, my most wisest short beings .

**Okweri:** we met the minister, we gave him 500k for his lunch, but I want to assure you, he is a very good guy( *one whispers in chiefs ear.*)

Look there he is

**Chief:** the minister, the one who seats closer with the king, the man of all seasons, how is our king, (*man looks at this chief, no answer is given*)

We do everything possible for our community, we buying them fertiles and you can looked at that big goat, she is the one she is eating grass.

*(guy smiles and shakes the head)*

let us have some lunch then visit the hospitals and schools.

*(chief tells okweri)*

Go and mobilize some people to act as the sick people and in go tell some nurses to organize my home to act as the hospital

Nurses mobilize people and these people lie on beds, drips are put on their hands food is given to them. They wait for the minister.

Minister walks in with the chief, you know,

Sick person speaks up

Thanks for the care our minister, here we heal before we are even treated.

The care is so awesome

Guy moves out very excited.

Shakes hands with chief, thanks for the work done,

And the 200k you gave me for lunch, as part of appreciation , we shall add you more 1.5 billions.

**Chiefs:** actually that's not much, because even that money, we will spend it in the community.

*( guy leaves so excited)*

### **BACK TO THE FAMILY**

*(man returns home, isn't around)*

**Oberi:** Jane jane, get me some food

*(wife comes with a sauce pan, gets the food and throws the food to the man.*

*Man looks at the wife and shakes the head*

*Wife stands ready to listen from the man, but man only seats to eat the food, okweri comes with the minister)*

**Oberi:** welcome, what bring you here, and who is this,

**Okweri:** this is the minister the king sent ,

**Oberi's wife:** *(kneels down welcomes the guy) you are welcome our minister moves out right and left confused, smiles walks around smiling gets the husband's left over food, smiles and takes it away).*

**Oberi:** welcome minister( *minister sits down*)

*(oberi moves out with okweri, complaining)*

Why did you bring this guy here

**Okweri:** you are the only poor person on the committee, we don't want to expose our wealth to this man.

Mind you we even told him that, we use part of our salaries to support the village works.

So allow this man to sleep here, it might even be of benefit to you( *moves away happily*)

*(oberi seats down touches the cheeks and moves off stage)*

**Man:** *(moves around to make a call, oberi hides to listen to him)*

Listen, am bringing your money with me, don't bring any police, I assure you, I have your money.

*(listens a bit , some guys here, think am the minister sent by the king, so they have given me the money and I have told them am leaving tomorrow)*

*(when he goes away, he meets the oberi's wife)*

What are you doing here

**Wife:** you see,you are a very good and handsome man, am here with my brother, soooo, I was suggesting that you take me to be your company.

*(oberi smiles and says)*

**Man:** I have an important meeting with the king tomorrow, so let me first reach there and I will call you.

*(Wife moves away, finds oberi moving up and down, very angry)*

**Oberi:** Why are you doing this to me, have I not provided enough to you.

**Wife:** what have I gained from this stupid relationship, *(in an angry voice)*nothing nothing completely, you leave me with only 50 thousand, *(shouts at the man)* what can 50k do, *(shouts again)*answer me, now listen, am leaving you for good useless man.

*(man tries to get her hand but, the lady puts the man down, man cries)*

**Oberi:** *( gets the phone )* I need to expose this man, he is even taking away my wife.*( calls chief)*

Chief , I want to tell you something.

**Chief:** give me peace, you are the enemies of money, development

**Oberi:** its urgent chief.

**Chief:** you have never spoken any sense, given me peace. Switches off the phone

*(Oberi moves off stage)*

## **THE ENDING**

*Oberi rushes to meet the chief,*

*Chief is taking tea*

**Oberi:** you see, that guy is not the minister, I heard him calling (*chief freezes*)

**Chief:** I don't know what makes you think I will accept this nonsense you are telling me.

(*Other committee members come in*)

I have never seen such senseless dwarfs like you, you gave out my money 200k and told me you gave the guy 500k,

The guy you giving the money is a wrong guy, he is not the minister.

What will we go to do.

**Oberi:** no chief you are very arrogant, I used to tell you and you chose to ignore my advice.

**Gally:** but still you are nothing to this committee, (*hears knock chief says come in, the secretary comes, tells the chief*) don't you even dare call our chief arrogant.

**Secretary:** someone needs you outside.

Chief: (*shouts*) I don't want to see any one ( *secretary moves out*)

( *two police officers come, salutes the chief*)(*committee members run out one by one*)

**Policemen:** chief wogweri of Addaho village, the king wants to meet you outside.

(*chief freezes throws the glass down, starts shivering, they leave stage* )